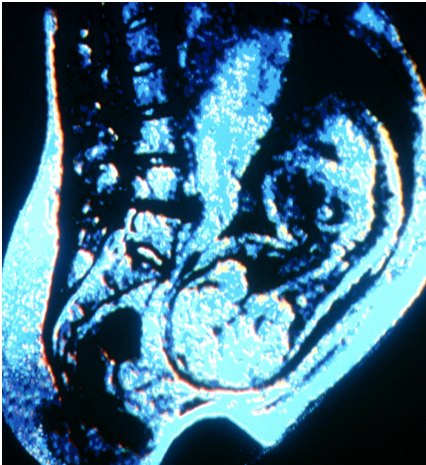




YOU ARE **34 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

37 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This is an MRI image showing a cross section of the entire pregnancy. The mother's spine is on the left of the image, and the baby is lying head down within the pelvis. An MRI is rarely needed during pregnancy, but if recommended, it is entirely safe.

“You’ll probably find yourself analyzing every ache and pain in these final weeks of your pregnancy.”

By this stage of pregnancy every time you get a twinge you may worry that it's the onset of labor. This is a normal concern, but try to remember that, even though you're heavily pregnant, most aches and pains are still likely to be due to constipation, or stretching ligaments, rather than labor.

You may begin to have Braxton Hicks contractions; these practice contractions occur as the uterus tightens as a warm-up for labor. They also help direct more blood to the placenta in the final weeks of pregnancy. Some women are unaware of them, while for others they can be quite uncomfortable. Relaxing the uterine muscles by changing your position, walking around, or taking a warm bath can help.

If you're unsure whether the pains you're having are Braxton Hicks, always consult your doctor.

ASK A MOM

What will I need if I'm planning to breastfeed? I found all the following items really useful:

- **Nursing bras** that can be unclipped at the front or have zip-open cups. Get properly fitted (bearing in mind that your breasts will be bigger once your milk comes in). You'll need several nursing bras.
- **Nipple cream:** this is soothing if you have cracked nipples.
- **Breast pads** (disposable or washable). Slip them inside your bra to absorb any leaks between feedings. Alternatively, breast shells slot inside your bra to catch any excess milk.
- **Breastfeeding pillow:** a V-shaped pillow isn't essential, but it will help you and your baby get comfortable.
- **Burp cloths** to catch dribbles.
- **Breast pump** and bottles or bags for storing expressed milk.

PREPARING FOR BREASTFEEDING
